THE GAZETTE OF INDIA, JULY 4, 2009 (ASADHA 13, 1931) [PART III—SEC. 4]

UNIVERSITY GRANTS COMMISSION

UGC REGULATIONS ON CURBING THE MENACE OF RAGGING IN HIGHER EDUCATIONAL INSTITUTIONS, 2009

(Under Section 26 (1)(g) of the University Grants Commission Act, 1956)
New Delhi-110002, the 17th June 2009 • F.1-16/2007(CPP-II)

PREAMBLE

In view of the directions of the Hon'ble Supreme Court in the matter of *"University of Kerala v/s. Council, Principals, Colleges and others"* in SLP no. 24295 of 2006 dated 16.05.2007 and dated 8.05.2009 in Civil Appeal number 887 of 2009, and in consideration of the determination of the Central Government and the University Grants Commission to prohibit, prevent and eliminate the scourge of ragging including any conduct by any student or students whether by words spoken or written or by an act which has the effect of teasing, treating or handling with rudeness a fresher or any other student, or indulging in rowdy or indisciplined activities by any student or students which causes or is likely to cause annoyance, hardship or psychological harm or to raise fear or apprehension thereof in any fresher or any other student or asking any student to do any act which such student will not in the ordinary course do and which has the effect of causing or generating a sense of shame, or torment or embarrassment so as to adversely affect the physique or psyche of such fresher or any other student, with or without an intent to derive a sadistic pleasure or showing off power, authority or superiority by a student over any fresher or any other student, in all higher education institutions in the country, and thereby, to provide for the healthy development, physically and psychologically, of all students, the University Grants Commission, in consultation with the Councils, brings forth this Regulation.

In exercise of the powers conferred by Clause (g) of sub-section (1) of Section 26 of the University Grants Commission Act, 1956, the University Grants Commission hereby makes the following Regulations, namely:

1. TITLE, COMMENCEMENT AND APPLICABILITY

- **1.1 Title:** These regulations shall be called the *"UGC Regulations on Curbing the Menace of Ragging in Higher Educational Institutions, 2009"* (as amended).
- **1.2 Commencement:** They shall come into force from the date of their publication in the Official Gazette.
- **1.3 Applicability:** They shall apply to all institutions coming within the definition of a University under sub-section (f) of section (2) of the University Grants Commission Act, 1956, to all institutions deemed to be a university under Section 3 of the UGC Act, 1956, to all other higher educational institutions, or elements of such universities or institutions, including its departments, constituent units and all premises, whether academic, residential, playgrounds, canteen, or other such premises whether located within the campus or outside, and to all means of transportation of students, whether public or private, accessed by students for the pursuit of studies.

2. OBJECTIVES

To prohibit any conduct by any student or students whether by words spoken or written or by an act which has the effect of teasing, treating or handling with rudeness a fresher or any other student, or indulging in rowdy or indisciplined activities which cause annoyance, hardship, psychological harm, or apprehension; asking any student to do any act generating shame, torment, or embarrassment affecting physique or psyche; and thereby to eliminate ragging in all its forms from higher educational institutions in the country by prohibiting it under these Regulations, preventing its occurrence, and punishing those who indulge in ragging.

3. WHAT CONSTITUTES RAGGING

Ragging constitutes one or more of any of the following acts (with or without an intent to derive a sadistic pleasure or showing off power, authority or superiority by a student over any fresher or any other student):

1. Any conduct by any student or students whether by words spoken or written or by an act which has the effect of teasing, treating or handling with rudeness a fresher or any other student;

2. Indulging in rowdy or indisciplined activities by any student or students which causes or is likely to cause annoyance, hardship, physical or psychological harm or to raise fear or apprehension thereof in any fresher or any other student;
3. Asking any student to do any act which such student will not in the ordinary course do and which has the effect of causing or generating a sense of shame, or torment or embarrassment so as to adversely affect the physique or psyche of such fresher or any other student;
4. Any act by a senior student that prevents, disrupts or disturbs the regular academic activity of any other student or a fresher;
5. Exploiting the services of a fresher or any other student for completing the academic tasks assigned to an individual or a group of students;
6. Any act of financial extortion or forceful expenditure burden put on a fresher or any other student by students;
7. Any act of physical abuse including all variants of it: sexual abuse, homosexual assaults, stripping, forcing obscene and lewd acts, gestures, causing bodily harm or any other danger to health or person;
8. Any act or abuse by spoken words, emails, post, public insults which would also include deriving perverted pleasure, vicarious or sadistic thrill from actively or passively participating in the discomfiture to fresher or any other student;
9. Any act that affects the mental health and self-confidence of a fresher or any other student;
10. *(Inserted via Third Amendment, 2016):* Any act of physical or mental abuse (including bullying and exclusion) targeted at another student (fresher or otherwise) on the ground of colour, race, religion, caste, ethnicity, gender (including transgender), sexual orientation, appearance, nationality, regional origins, linguistic identity, place of birth, place of residence or economic background.

4. DEFINITIONS

1. In these regulations unless the context otherwise requires:
    1. **"Act":** Means the University Grants Commission Act, 1956 (3 of 1956);
    2. **"Academic year":** Means the period from commencement of admission of students in any course of study up to the completion of academic requirements for that particular year;
    3. **"Anti-Ragging Helpline":** Means the Helpline established under clause (a) of Regulation 8.1;
    4. **"Commission":** Means the University Grants Commission;
    5. **"Council":** Means a statutory body constituted by an Act of Parliament or State Legislature for coordinating/ maintaining standards in higher education (such as AICTE, BCI, DCI, DEC, ICAR, INC, MCI, NCTE, PCI, State Higher Education Councils, etc.);
    6. **"District Level Anti-Ragging Committee":** Means the Committee headed by the District Magistrate constituted by the State Government;
    7. **"Head of the institution":** Means the Vice-Chancellor in case of a university/deemed university, or Principal/ Director/Executive Head of the institution/college;
    8. **"Fresher":** Means a student who has been admitted to an institution and who is undergoing his/her first year of study;
    9. **"Institution":** Means a higher educational institution imparting education beyond 12 years of schooling leading to a degree or diploma;
    10. **"NAAC":** Means the National Assessment and Accreditation Council;
    11. **"State Level Monitoring Cell":** Means the body constituted by the State Government for the control and elimination of ragging.
2. Words and expressions used and not defined herein but defined in the Act or in the General Clauses Act, 1897, shall have the meanings respectively assigned to them.

5. MEASURES FOR PROHIBITION OF RAGGING AT THE INSTITUTION LEVEL

1. No institution or any part thereof, including departments, constituent units, colleges, centres of studies, and premises (academic, residential, sports, canteen, private/public student transport), shall permit or condone any reported incident of ragging in any form. All institutions must take required measures to eliminate ragging.

2. All institutions shall take action in accordance with these Regulations against those found guilty of ragging and/or abetting ragging, actively or passively, or being part of a conspiracy to promote ragging.

6. MEASURES FOR PREVENTION OF RAGGING AT THE INSTITUTION LEVEL

6.1 Admission or Registration Stage:

1. Every public admission announcement across all media must expressly declare that ragging is totally prohibited and violators are liable to penal and regulatory punishments.
2. Prospectuses and admission brochures must print these Regulations in full, highlighting the Anti-Ragging Helpline and contact details of heads, faculty, committees, squads, and district authorities.
3. Affiliating universities shall ensure affiliated institutions strictly comply with brochure notices.
4. Application forms must contain mandatory undertakings/affidavits signed by the student in English, Hindi, or a regional language (Annexure I).
5. Application forms must contain mandatory undertakings/affidavits signed by parents/guardians (Annexure II).
6. Applications must be accompanied by conduct/transfer certificates indicating interpersonal/social behavioral background from the last institution attended.
7. Hostel application requires additional affidavits by students and parents.
8. Pre-session coordination meetings must be convened by the Head of Institution with wardens, student/parent representatives, faculty, and local police administration.
9. Prominent display of anti-ragging posters and penal consequences at vulnerable spots and notice boards.
10. Engagement of media to publicize anti-ragging resolves.
11. Identification, thorough illumination, and surveillance of vulnerable spots.
12. Tightened security and intense patrolling by Anti-Ragging Squads and volunteers at odd hours during initial months.
13. Vacation publicity campaigns using posters and leaflets.
14. Pre-planned induction arrangements catering to special needs of student groups.
15. Engagement of professional counsellors prior to and during the academic session.
16. Providing details of privately managed student hostels/lodges to local police for vigilant patrolling.

6.2 Steps on Admission, Enrolment, and Registration:

1. Issuing freshers printed help leaflets containing emergency numbers (Helpline, Wardens, Squad, Police).
2. Leaflets explaining induction, orientation, and integration arrangements.
3. Instructing freshers about their rights to resist irregular commands and report ragging immediately.
4. Calendar of events and activities to facilitate familiarization.
5. Scheduling joint orientation sessions, counsellor interactions, address by Head of Institution, and large-scale cultural/ sports interactive platforms; faculty dining with hostel residents.
6. Setting up healthy interaction monitoring committees.
7. Encouraging reporting with guaranteed protection of informant identity.
8. Assigning freshers to small faculty-mentored groups with daily interaction check-ins.
9. Faculty mentor visits to hostels and maintenance of mentor diaries.
10. Separate hostel blocks for freshers where possible, with strictly monitored senior access.
11. Round-the-clock hostel vigil.
12. Parental duty to report instances promptly.
13. Mandatory annual submission and electronic record maintenance of student/parent undertakings.
14. Mandatory reporting of residential details (especially private hostels/lodges) by students.
15. Sector apportionment among faculty to monitor transit routes and student commuting.
16. Annual appeal letters to parents of students completing their first year.

6.3 Institutional Bodies to be Constituted:

1. **Anti-Ragging Committee:** Nominated and chaired by Head of Institution; composed of civil and police administration, local media, youth NGOs, faculty, parents, freshers, seniors, and non-teaching staff with diverse representation and gender balance. Oversees overall compliance and ARS performance.
2. **Anti-Ragging Squad:** Smaller, highly mobile internal campus body with diverse campus community representation (no outside members). Conducts surprise inspections and raids on hostels and vulnerable premises.
3. **Enquiry by ARS:** Conducts on-the-spot enquiries adhering to natural justice, hearing accused and witnesses, and submitting report with recommendations to Anti-Ragging Committee.
4. **Mentoring Cell:** Volunteer student mentors formed at end of academic year (ratio: 1 mentor per 6 freshers; tiered structure).
5. **University Monitoring Cell:** Coordinates affiliated college anti-ragging efforts, gathers reports, and interfaces with District Level Anti-Ragging Committees.

6.4 Other Institutional Measures:

- Full-time resident hostel wardens with communication facilities (provided mobile phones) and direct control over security personnel.
- Unrestricted phone/mobile access for students to communicate with Anti-Ragging Helplines (except during classes/ library).
- Sensitization undertakings from all teaching, non-teaching, outsourced, and canteen staff to report ragging. Appreciation certificates for whistleblowers.
- Teacher-training curriculums (B.Ed/M.Ed) to integrate anti-ragging, human rights, and counselling skills.
- Fortnightly discreet random surveys among freshers during initial three months.
- Migration/Transfer certificates to specifically record any disciplinary punishment or persistent aggressive conduct.
- Affiliated heads must submit weekly reports for the first 3 months and monthly thereafter to the Vice Chancellor; Vice Chancellors submit fortnightly reports to State Level Monitoring Cells.

7. ACTION BY THE HEAD OF THE INSTITUTION & POLICE FIR

On receipt of recommendations from ARS or information of ragging, the Head of the Institution must determine if a penal offence is made out, and if so, file a **First Information Report (FIR) within 24 hours** with the local police under appropriate Indian Penal Code provisions relating to:

1. Abetment to ragging;
2. Criminal conspiracy to rag;
3. Unlawful assembly and rioting while ragging;
4. Public nuisance created during ragging;
5. Violation of decency and morals through ragging;
6. Injury to body, causing hurt or grievous hurt;
7. Wrongful restraint;
8. Wrongful confinement;
9. Use of criminal force;
10. Assault as well as sexual offences or unnatural offences;
11. Extortion;
12. Criminal trespass;
13. Offences against property;
14. Criminal intimidation;
15. Attempts or threats to commit any or all of the above offences;
16. Physical or psychological humiliation;
17. All other offences flowing from the definition of "Ragging".

Provided that institutional internal enquiry under Regulation 9 must continue concurrently without awaiting police outcome and be concluded within 7 days.

8. DUTIES OF THE COMMISSION AND COUNCILS

- **8.1 Communication Facilitation:** Toll-free 24x7 Anti-Ragging Helpline with simultaneous message relays to institution heads, wardens, university nodal officers, and District Magistrates/SPs. Maintenance of centralized database of affidavits and complaints accessible to authorized monitoring NGOs.
- **8.2 Regulatory Actions:** Mandatory compliance conditions tied to UGC general/special grants and Utilization Certificates; adverse impacts on NAAC accreditation/grading for institutions failing to control ragging; Inter-Council Committee bi-annual coordination meetings; establishment of an internal UGC Anti-Ragging Cell.

9. ADMINISTRATIVE ACTION & PENALTIES

9.1 Punishments for Students:
The Anti-Ragging Committee may award one or more of the following punishments:

1. Suspension from attending classes and academic privileges.
2. Withholding / withdrawing scholarship / fellowship and other benefits.
3. Debarring from appearing in any test / examination or evaluation process.
4. Withholding results.
5. Debarring from representing the institution in regional, national, or international meets, tournaments, or youth festivals.
6. Suspension / expulsion from hostel.
7. Cancellation of admission.
8. Rustication from the institution for a period ranging from 1 to 4 semesters.
9. Expulsion from the institution and consequent debarring from admission to any other institution for a specified period.
10. Collective punishment where individual perpetrators cannot be identified.

Appeals: Appeal lies to the Vice-Chancellor (for affiliated/constituent colleges), Chancellor (for Universities), or Chairman/Chancellor (for Institutes of National Importance).

9.2 Action Against Non-Compliant Institutions:
Universities may withdraw affiliation/recognition, withhold degree awards, or withhold university grants. The UGC may withdraw 12B status, freeze grants-in-aid, declare the institution lacking minimum academic standards to the public via national press and website, or take other statutory actions.

9.3 Disciplinary Action Against Staff:
Departmental disciplinary proceedings shall be initiated against faculty or staff displaying apathy, insensitivity, or failure to report/prevent ragging, without prejudice to penal action for criminal abetment.

(Dr. R.K. Chauhan)
Secretary, UGC

Gazette Summary of Amendments Incorporated:

- **Amendment 2012 (No. F. 15-3/2012):** Substituted title to *"Curbing the Menace of Ragging in Higher Educational Institutions Regulations"*; shifted designated agency reporting directly to UGC.
- **Second Amendment 2013 (No. F. 15-3/2013 Pt. III):** Replaced notarized affidavits before Oath Commissioners with verified self-undertakings by student and parent/guardian.
- **Third Amendment 2016 (No. F. 1-15-/2009):** Added explicit clause 3(j) covering bullying and exclusion on grounds of race, color, religion, caste, ethnicity, gender, sexual orientation, appearance, nationality, regional origin, or economic background.

ANNEXURE I: UNDERTAKING BY THE STUDENT

I, _____ (full name of student with admission/registration/enrolment number) s/o d/o Mr./Mrs./ Ms. _____, having been admitted to _____ (name of the institution), have received a copy of the UGC Regulations on Curbing the Menace of Ragging in Higher Educational Institutions, 2009, (hereinafter called the "Regulations") carefully read and fully understood the provisions contained in the said Regulations.

1. I have, in particular, perused clause 3 of the Regulations and am aware as to what constitutes ragging.
2. I have also, in particular, perused clause 7 and clause 9.1 of the Regulations and am fully aware of the penal and administrative action that is liable to be taken against me in case I am found guilty of or abetting ragging, actively or passively, or being part of a conspiracy to promote ragging.
3. I hereby solemnly aver and undertake that:
    1. I will not indulge in any behaviour or act that may be constituted as ragging under clause 3 of the Regulations.
    2. I will not participate in or abet or propagate through any act of commission or omission that may be constituted as ragging under clause 3 of the Regulations.
4. I hereby affirm that, if found guilty of ragging, I am liable for punishment according to clause 9.1 of the Regulations, without prejudice to any other criminal action that may be taken against me under any penal law or any law for the time being in force.
5. I hereby declare that I have not been expelled or debarred from admission in any institution in the country on account of being found guilty of, abetting or being part of a conspiracy to promote ragging; and further affirm that, in case the declaration is found to be untrue, I am aware that my admission is liable to be cancelled.

Declared this ____ day of _____ month of ____ year.

Signature of deponent: _____ **Name:** _____

VERIFICATION:

Verified that the contents of this undertaking are true to the best of my knowledge and no part of the undertaking is false and nothing has been concealed or misstated therein.

Verified at (place) _____ on this the (day) ____ of (month) _____, (year) ____.

Signature of deponent: _____ **Name:** _____

ANNEXURE II: UNDERTAKING BY PARENT / GUARDIAN

I, Mr./Mrs./Ms. _____ (full name of parent/guardian) father/mother/guardian of _____ (full name of student with admission/registration/enrolment number), having been admitted to _____ (name of the Institution), have received a copy of the UGC Regulations on Curbing the Menace of Ragging in Higher Educational Institutions, 2009, (hereinafter called the "Regulations"), carefully read and fully understood the provisions contained in the said Regulations.

1. I have, in particular, perused clause 3 of the Regulations and am aware as to what constitutes ragging.
2. I have also, in particular, perused clause 7 and clause 9.1 of the Regulations and am fully aware of the penal and administrative action that is liable to be taken against my ward in case he/she is found guilty of or abetting ragging, actively or passively, or being part of a conspiracy to promote ragging.
3. I hereby solemnly aver and undertake that:
    1. My ward will not indulge in any behaviour or act that may be constituted as ragging under clause 3 of the Regulations.
    2. My ward will not participate in or abet or propagate through any act of commission or omission that may be constituted as ragging under clause 3 of the Regulations.
4. I hereby affirm that, if found guilty of ragging, my ward is liable for punishment according to clause 9.1 of the Regulations, without prejudice to any other criminal action that may be taken against my ward under any penal law or any law for the time being in force.
5. I hereby declare that my ward has not been expelled or debarred from admission in any institution in the country on account of being found guilty of, abetting or being part of a conspiracy to promote ragging; and further affirm that, in case the declaration is found to be untrue, the admission of my ward is liable to be cancelled.

Declared this ____ day of _____ month of ____ year.

Signature of deponent: _____
Name: _____ **Address:** _____
Telephone/Mobile No.: _____

VERIFICATION:
Verified that the contents of this undertaking are true to the best of my knowledge and no part of the undertaking is false and nothing has been concealed or misstated therein.
Verified at (place) _____ on this the (day) ____ of (month) _____, (year) ____.

Signature of deponent: _____ **Name:** _____